



Lawrence & Hanson – Gordon Macdonald

MN-55013

Phase 1 Determination

Acquisition may be put into effect

5 May 2026

1. Determination and statement of reasons

Notified acquisition	Lawrence & Hanson Group Pty Ltd (Lawrence & Hanson) proposes to acquire the business and assets of Gordon Macdonald Pty Ltd (Gordon Macdonald) (the Acquisition).
Determination	The Australian Competition and Consumer Commission has determined under section 51ABZE(1) of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) that the Acquisition may be put into effect.
Parties to the Acquisition	The acquirer, Lawrence & Hanson, is an Australian wholesaler of electrical, lighting and data products, primarily to trade and industrial customers. It operates premises across Australia, including in Nowra and Wollongong in New South Wales. Lawrence & Hanson is owned by Sonepar, a French headquartered, global distributor of electrical products and related services. The target, Gordon Macdonald, is a New South Wales based wholesaler of electrical, lighting and data products, primarily to trade and industrial customers. Gordon Macdonald currently has premises in Bowral, Nowra and Wollongong.
Overlap between the parties	Lawrence & Hanson and Gordon Macdonald overlap in the supply of wholesale electrical, lighting and data products in Nowra and Wollongong.
Reasons for determination	When making a determination in Phase 1, the Australian Competition and Consumer Commission (ACCC) undertakes a competition assessment and considers whether it is appropriate for an acquisition to be approved or subject to further assessment in Phase 2 in accordance with section 51ABZJ of the <i>Competition and Consumer Act 2010</i> (Cth) (the Act). In doing so, the ACCC must have regard to the object of the Act and all relevant matters, including the interests of consumers. For more information about the ACCC's approach to considering notified acquisitions, see the ACCC's merger assessment guidelines and interim merger process guidelines. In conducting its competition assessment, the ACCC has considered the information and documents that were submitted with the notification form and publicly available information. The ACCC has determined that the Acquisition may be put into effect as it considers that the Acquisition is unlikely to have the effect of substantially lessening competition in any market. In reaching its decision, and based on the material before it, the ACCC makes the following findings. • Laurence & Hanson would continue to have a small market share in the supply of wholesale electrical, lighting and/or data products in the Illawarra/Shoalhaven area. • Laurence & Hanson would likely continue to be constrained by alternative suppliers of electrical, lighting and/or data products to business customers proximate to Gordon Macdonald's premises in each of Bowral, Nowra and Wollongong as well as from online suppliers of such products.

Applications for review	A notifying party, or other person who has been allowed to do so by the Australian Competition Tribunal, may apply for review if they are dissatisfied with the determination. Pursuant to section 100C of the Act, applications for review of the determination are to be made to the Australian Competition Tribunal before the end of 14 calendar days after this statement of reasons was included on the ACCC's Acquisitions Register. To confirm whether there has been any application for review, please contact the Australian Competition Tribunal.
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Determination made by Commissioner Philip Williams pursuant to a delegation under section 25(1) of the Act